

00 A TALK —

Building fast is solved. Deciding well is not.

A talk on a career break, 2026.

Robert Blust · Software Engineer & Architect

01 THE CLAIM

The constraint moved.

Decide well over build fast: “AI moved the constraint from building quickly to deciding correctly; **the decision is the work.**”

A value in the model, quoted as it stands there.

One question, four months.

June to September 2026: what to do next, tested by building in the open.

| It ended with a decision, not only an offer.

Building fast, measured.

23

public repositories in 3 organizations

5,065

commits on default branches

1,640

merged pull requests

272

releases

9

live hosts

91%

of non-merge commits co-authored with Claude

One person. As of Sep 24, 2026.

The curve.



Building is not the expensive part any more.

about CHF 650

for the subscription in four months, paid

about CHF 9,000

of compute at API list price

about 16 billion

tokens, most of them context read again

It rests on a few providers' prices and terms. The knowledge is portable; **the speed is not yet.**

What the same result would have cost a Swiss team: blust.ch/talks/deciding-well/cost

Where the time went instead.

95

specs

105

plans

5

phases, each behind a gate

Shape · Spec · Plan · Implement · Integrate — **the Owner merges.**

Taken, revised, dropped.

1,360

decisions written down in 95 specs

72

revised later

30

dropped or parked

1,258

still standing as written

1

revert in 5,065 commits

12

repositories in one release wave, replaced the same day

An agent had to read them out of prose. Next, decisions become part of the model.

The answer: one graph.

CompanyGraph: vision, strategy, roles, processes, rules and their evidence as one graph, for people and agents.

Plain Markdown in git, served over MCP — **no provider owns it.**

It runs.

blust.ch

the mental model of Robert Blust, a company of one
site · MCP server · chat

companygraph.io

the mental model of CompanyGraph, describing itself
site · MCP server · chat

guestgraph.io

the mental model of GuestGraph
site · MCP server · chat
and the product in code: the open-core engine and the Apaleo
connector

Three mental models, each in git, each served three ways. Ask a chat a question its model can answer.

CompanyGraph and GuestGraph are **ready for scrutiny**: open core, validated in the open.

Deciding well is the work.

Building fast is solved. Deciding well is not.

My proposal: decide well with a mental model and agentic AI.

Validate it with me.

`blust.ch · companygraph.io · guestgraph.io` — from October, an IT architect role, chosen over better-paid engineering and lead roles; from 2027, education in how AI is led and governed.

Where to start reading.

THE ARGUMENT

The values

blust.ch/principles

Who decides what

blust.ch/team

THE PROOF

Every claim, with its evidence

blust.ch/model

The career as a ledger

blust.ch/timeline

What a team would have cost

blust.ch/talks/deciding-well/cost

THE ANSWER

Everything a company knows, one graph

companygraph.io

Where the model is published

companygraph.io/surfaces

Two ideas, put up for scrutiny

blust.ch/ideas